



INTERNAL BUSINESS CASE

The business case for modern B2B ordering

Prepared for wholesale, distribution, and manufacturing teams evaluating how their buyers place orders.

For companies with \$15–300M in revenue and high-volume wholesale ordering

2026 edition

Why this is on the agenda now

B2B purchasing has moved online while overall B2B trade has stayed flat. The growth is not in more buyers — it is in a larger share of the same buyers ordering digitally, and choosing suppliers by how easy that is.

\$2.93T U.S. B2B ecommerce in 2025, up 13% while total B2B sales stayed roughly flat	39% of B2B buyers will place orders above \$500K through digital self-service — up from 28% two years earlier
94% of smartphone time is spent inside apps rather than a browser	>40% of revenue at leading B2B organizations is driven or influenced by mobile

The practical consequence: the ordering experience is no longer a back-office system. It is the surface your customers judge you on, and the point at which they decide whether to reorder or call somebody else.

What the current setup usually costs

Most mid-market wholesalers are running one of three things: an aging ERP portal, a general-purpose ecommerce platform bent into B2B shape, or phone-and-email order entry. Each carries a cost that rarely appears as a line item.

Catalog performance	Platforms built for consumer retail slow down at wholesale catalog sizes. Buyers abandon search and call a rep, which converts a self-service order into a staffed one.
Per-seat licensing	Charging per user means the warehouse team, the field reps, and the customer's own staff are rationed. The people who would use the system most are the ones left out.
Percentage-of-GMV fees	Fees tied to order volume mean your platform cost rises exactly as you succeed. Growth is taxed rather than supported.
Implementation drag	Mid-market B2B builds on general platforms commonly run four to eight months or more before launch, with integration work billed throughout.
Manual catalog upkeep	Product data maintained by hand across PDFs, spreadsheets, and the ERP consumes staff time continuously and still drifts out of date.

What RocketX changes

Millions of SKUs, sub-second search

Filter and order across millions of items in milliseconds — performance other platforms do not match at this scale.

Unlimited seats and users

Every employee, rep, and authorised customer gets full access. No per-user fees, no rationing.

Customer-specific pricing

Each buyer sees their negotiated prices, volume breaks, and contract terms automatically.

Order directly from PDFs

AI reads existing brochures and catalogs so buyers order straight from them — no re-keying.

Native iOS and Android apps

Purpose-built for B2B ordering, not a wrapped website. Full catalog in the buyer's pocket.

Real-time cart collaboration

Multiple team members work the same cart at once, with every action logged — who, what, when.

Live inventory across warehouses

Real-time stock and availability, so buyers stop ordering what cannot ship.

Deep ERP and CRM integration

Two-way sync with NetSuite, SAP, Microsoft Dynamics, Epicor, and other major systems.

Why the native app matters commercially

A responsive website and a native app are not the same product. For repeat wholesale ordering the difference shows up directly in order frequency.

Reordering is a habit, not a search

Most B2B orders are repeat orders. A browser makes the buyer find a bookmark, load a site, and log in every time. An app is one tap, already signed in — friction removed from every reorder for the life of the account.

A permanent position on the buyer's phone

Your icon sits on the home screen. Competitors have to be searched for and rediscovered.

Push reaches buyers that email does not

Back-in-stock alerts, contract renewals, and reorder reminders arrive directly. Users who opt into push retain at two to three times the rate of those who do not.

The work happens away from a desk

Buyers order from warehouse aisles, loading docks, and trade-show floors. Native camera access means barcode scanning and reorder from a shelf label.

It survives losing signal

Steel-walled warehouses and rural routes kill reception. The catalog, pricing, and cart stay local and sync when the connection returns.

How the commercial terms reduce risk

The structure of the agreement is designed so the platform proves itself before it costs anything. No figures are quoted here — current pricing is on the website and in your proposal.

Flat fee, never a percentage of GMV

Platform cost does not rise because your order volume did. Growth is not taxed.

Unlimited seats included

No per-user pricing to negotiate or ration as the team grows.

Setup and integration fee waived on annual plans

The implementation cost that usually front-loads these projects is removed.

Billing starts at go-live, not at signature

You pay nothing until the platform is live and delivering value.

30–45 day pilot with joint ROI review

A defined evaluation window with agreed measures, before a longer commitment.

Native apps and standard integrations included

Not sold as add-on modules on top of a base licence.

What implementation looks like

01 1. Stack audit

We map the existing catalog, pricing rules, ERP, and order flow, and identify what has to move and what stays.

02 2. Integration

Two-way sync is built against your ERP and CRM. Standard connectors cover the major systems; anything beyond standard scope is quoted as a defined block of work.

03 3. Catalog ingestion

Existing PDFs, brochures, and product data are read in. No manual re-keying of the catalog.

04 4. Pilot

A 30–45 day live pilot with a defined buyer group and agreed success measures.

05 5. Go-live and review

Full rollout, with a joint ROI review against the measures agreed at pilot.

Questions worth asking any vendor

? Does the platform fee change as our order volume grows?

? Are field reps and our customers' staff charged as seats?

? What is the search response time at our actual catalog size, not a demo catalog?

? Are the mobile apps native, or a website in an app shell?

? Does the catalog work when a buyer has no signal?

? When does billing start — at signature or at go-live?

? What happens to our data and integrations if we leave?

Next step

A personalised demo against your own catalog, a short stack audit, and a low-risk pilot with measurable results within weeks.

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SOURCES

Digital Commerce 360 / U.S. Department of Commerce for B2B ecommerce totals and growth. McKinsey B2B Pulse, ninth annual survey of 3,942 B2B decision makers across 13 countries, for digital order values. Sensor Tower, State of Mobile 2026, for share of smartphone time outside the browser; this figure covers all smartphone use, not B2B ordering specifically. Boston Consulting Group with Google, "Mobile Marketing and the New B2B Buyer" (2017), for mobile's share of B2B revenue. Airship retention benchmarks for push opt-in. Implementation timelines reflect 2026 market benchmarks for mid-market B2B builds and vary by scope.